



सुवर्ण महोत्सव महाराष्ट्राचा

Aurangabad, Nagpur and Nasik are developing as the future IT zones. Due to the 2006 IT policy of the state around 80 IT Parks are now established here. The state's new IT Policy has been announced. This will benefit the tier-II cities in the state.

Q. What has been the State Government's role in the development of industries in the underdeveloped regions of the state?

Due to the encouragement for the private and public sector investment and the simultaneous boost for vocational and technical education, the smaller towns and the lesser developed regions of the state are getting increased opportunities for attracting investment. Regular aviation services have started in Nanded and Latur districts and Aurangabad has come up on the international aviation map. There have been new industrial projects in the lesser developed areas like Marathwada and Vidharbha. The State Government is also facilitating investments from major industries in Mumbai, Thane and Pune.

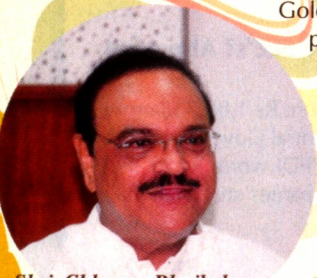
Q. Maharashtra has always been a fore runner for industrial development. Could you talk about this trend?

Maharashtra has a growth of nearly 9%. This year too, despite the economic slowdown we have shown growth. Though a major part of the country's population stays in the rural areas, 50% of Maharashtra's population is in urban areas leading to fresh requirements to be met. I am happy to inform that the Central Government has offered support for the development of transport infrastructure in all cities, on the lines of Mumbai. Also our state will receive large funds from the Jawaharlal Nehru National Urban Renewal Mission (JNNURM).

Q. What are the major decisions by the Maharashtra Industrial Development Corporation (MIDC) in the past five years?

MIDC has spent Rs. 210 crore in the development of airports at Nanded, Latur, Usmanabad, Yavatmal, Amravati and Baramati including the reinforcement of the runways, raising the security walls, construction of the terminal buildings, traffic control facilities etc. The privatization of Nanded, Latur, Usmanabad, Yavatmal and Baramati is underway.

During last five years, the State Government has implemented many schemes and programs to build a tough, capable and progressive Maharashtra ensuring all encompassing development. Maharashtra, taking steps towards its Golden Jubilee has always been a leader in pragmatic thinking. The State Government is leaving no stones unturned to ensure this leadership.



Shri. Chhagan Bhujbal
Hon'ble Deputy Chief Minister
of Maharashtra

On review of the works done and goals achieved during last five years, it is seen that huge amount of progress has been made for the sake of the farmers, students, women & minorities.

The State Government has made substantial contribution in the domain of rural and urban development, water resources

and infrastructure development. Today, Maharashtra's share in the funding from the Central Government for the entire nation is almost 50% and this alone underlines the amount of development work in progress in the State. There is no doubt that the pace and spectrum of development work undertaken during last five years is unprecedented.

Maharashtra has a rich heritage of political stalwarts like Yeshwantrao Chavan, Vasantnao Naik, Vasantdada Patil, Shankarrao Chavan and Sharad Pawar, Minister of Agriculture, Government of India. As Maharashtra steps in the Golden Jubilee Year, its infrastructure, social reforms and justice, agility of the State Government towards business and industries is generally compared with the developed nations across the globe.

At this point of time, the State Government is giving great emphasis on building roads and facilities. A major program is being executed to connect all the major townships in the State by four lane roads. This project is pegged to cost Rs. 12,000 crore. Many buildings in the public domain, the New Maharashtra Sadan in New Delhi, the High Mount Rest House in Mumbai and other projects were executed under this concept. The Public Works Department is doing an admirable job of building Dr. Babasaheb Ambedkar Bhavan for the Department of Social Justice, school buildings, hostels and buildings under the jail reforms scheme, various buildings for the tribal department, ITIs, ashrams, schools and rural hospitals.

Security is another very important and sensitive issue for the State. Especially after the 26/11 terrorist attack on Mumbai, the security of the state is a vital issue for the government. A Special Task Force at Minister Level has been convened under the leadership of Deputy Chief Minister Mr. Chhagan Bhujbal. This ministerial group is in charge to find what the police need and to ensure the fulfillment of the deficiencies. They persistently interact with all the relevant agencies including the coast guards, navy, RAW and the efforts have fructified in formation of 'Force One' which are now into action. Also, there have been new sanctions of funds for the modernisation of the Police Force, eventual training, better vehicles and weaponry.

Under the various schemes for social justice, Maharashtra has waived off the loans extended to beneficiaries through corporations under the jurisdiction of the Department for Social Justice. Further to this loans to the tune of Rs. 1243.03 crore have been distributed through various financial institutions. The State has started building more than 100 hostels for the backward class students across the State. On one hand, more than 96 lakh girl students now shall benefit with an increment in the scholarship and more than 12 lakh students shall be extended scholarships for post matriculate education.